

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner, Stablecoin Payments.*

Positioning, payments infrastructure expert with a decade of fintech and crypto depth, shipping owned products from backlog to production in regulated, technically demanding environments. ≤ 25 words.

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§ WHY AQUANOW

Aquanow is building the infrastructure layer that makes institutional crypto finance actually work at scale, not the token speculation on top, but the plumbing underneath: stablecoin settlements, custody, liquidity, and payment rails. That is precisely the layer I find most interesting, and the one where product ownership requires genuine technical depth rather than slide-deck distance from engineering. The posting names stablecoin payments, remittances, crypto payouts, and checkout acceptance as early-stage products that still need shaping, these are not maintenance tasks, they are zero-to-one calls made daily alongside a tech lead. *That is exactly the kind of ownership where my instinct to push into the customer workshop and redirect the product based on actual usage pays off fastest.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec generation and edge-case coverage
- **GitHub Copilot**, inline assist during API design reviews
- **Cursor**, rapid iteration on requirements and documentation
- **Lovable**, front-end prototyping before engineering commits
- **GPT**, stakeholder communication drafts and rapid summarisation
- **n8n**, agentic workflow design and multi-step automation
- **Gamma.app**, internal product demos and release comms

- **Framer**, interactive wireframes for UAT walkthroughs

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

REST APIs (design, authentication patterns, request/response structure, error handling, webhooks), Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD with Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

PHOENIX882.COM GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP →

A crypto-market backtesting engine and algorithmic decision framework, built and operated solo.

- Constructs and replays trading strategies against historical crypto market data, including perpetual futures and spot venues.
- Integrates liquidation heatmap data from Coinglass and Hyblock Capital into signal generation pipelines.
- Feeds a personal trading operation across Hyperliquid, Bitget, Jupiter, and 1inch, with cross-chain bridging via Across Protocol.
- Directly relevant to Aquanow's settlement and execution infrastructure: the same microstructure analysis, slippage, price impact, routing, merit-order, that informs smart stablecoin payment rail selection.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT AQUANOW

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Sit with the tech lead on each payment product, stablecoin settlements, remittances, crypto payouts, checkout, and map the current API surface, authentication patterns, and error-handling gaps before touching the backlog.

WEEK 2

Slice and prioritise.

Work through the backlog with the tech lead and business development stakeholders, cutting it to the highest-value stories and writing acceptance criteria tight enough for QA to sign off without a follow-up call.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Drive the first sprint review with both internal stakeholders and at least one external client, surface the friction, and feed findings back into the next release plan before the retrospective ends.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Aquanow Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Product Owner, Stablecoin Payments role in Dubai. My interest in this position is not incidental: I have spent the better part of a decade studying and participating in the infrastructure layer that makes digital asset markets function, stablecoins, custody, settlement rails, DEX routing, cross-chain bridging, and I have reached a point where I want to direct that knowledge into building products at an institutional scale, rather than continuing to study it from the outside.

On the product ownership side, the work I am proudest of has shared a common shape with what you describe: technically complex, early-stage, and owned deeply rather than managed at arm's length. At EMIL Group I took the Claims Center from concept to production with no precedent, restructuring an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams in the process, and cutting time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week. At Rohde & Schwarz I pushed my way into the customer workshops, instrumented two competing workflows, and redirected a product away from the beautiful UI that recorded zero clicks and toward the developer-code-first design people actually used. At CLINET Platforms I implemented a hospital information system interface myself, cutting a clinical workflow from thirty minutes to five. In each case the value came from staying close enough to the engineering reality to make the right call quickly, not from managing upwards.

The specific content of the Aquanow role maps well to what I already know. I am comfortable reading and contributing to REST API specifications, authentication patterns, request and response structures, error handling, webhooks, because I have worked in environments where the product owner who cannot engage at that level becomes a bottleneck rather than an accelerant. I understand stablecoin payment mechanics and the operational nuances of crypto

settlement from years of active use across centralised and decentralised venues, and from building my own backtesting and execution infrastructure. I am aware of the regulatory landscape, AML/KYC, Travel Rule, MSB licensing, because I owned compliance alignment at Kvitt Payment Solutions when it was acquired into the girocard ecosystem, and because I held Deputy IT Security Officer responsibility at the Federal Employment Agency.

I am also genuinely available for the Dubai role. I am willing to relocate to the UAE and work hybrid from your office there; this is an active preference rather than a reluctant concession. The time-zone overlap with your Canadian engineering teams you mention is a normal part of how I expect to work, not a hardship.

I would welcome the opportunity to go deeper on any of the above in a conversation.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Owner and Product Manager with 13 years of end-to-end ownership in regulated, technically demanding environments, payments, fintech, public-sector analytics, insurance, and defence AI. I drive continuous discovery, translate technical architecture into prioritised backlogs and well-formed user stories, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery. My default is to stay close enough to the engineering reality to contribute to API design conversations, not just to relay them.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Payments and Fintech: payment flow design, PSP integration, P2P and crypto payment UX, stablecoin settlements, girocard ecosystem, REST API specification (authentication, request/response, error handling, webhooks), AML/KYC and Travel Rule awareness, MSB licensing context.

Product Ownership: user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision, roadmap ownership, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, go-to-market support.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, agile release train, PI planning, velocity and burndown.

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional alignment, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Analytics and Data: KPI definition, funnel and churn analysis, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AND AEROSPACE AI 2024-2025

Introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD across a multinational team; rollout time fell from days to 30 minutes and the platform became hotfix-capable. Redirected the product from a UI-led design to a developer-code-first approach after instrumenting competing workflows with real usage data.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline; introduced Dagster and dbt to run quarterly imports without hand-holding. Migrated a bare-metal system into containers and carried a full UI relaunch through the same period. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE 2023

Cut a three-person team's roadmap to the top 10% of features; user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented the CGM hospital information system interface directly: clinical anamnesis fell from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure. Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production, cutting time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL AND
PAYMENTS 2021-2022

Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning. POS and forecourt payment systems.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · INTERIM PRODUCT OWNER · GOVERNMENT SECURE
DATA 2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B
2019-2020

Migrated a legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE CLINICAL
NETWORK 2017-2018

WLAN rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION
STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero to one solo: anonymity-until-payment B2B marketplace, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE
ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer enterprise encryption product that installs in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built a mobile group-based P2P payment product from zero; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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